

E060

Project Management Methodologies

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A state agency must build a bridge-inspection database whose requirements are fixed by law and will not change, and the contract requires sign-off at defined phase gates. The agency's CIO recently spoke at an agile conference. Which approach fits best?

- A. Kanban with no phase gates.
- B. Scrum, reflecting the CIO's interest in agile.
- C. A predictive (waterfall) approach.
- D. Agile, because agile is always faster.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which project is the strongest candidate for an adaptive (agile) approach?

- A. Upgrading payroll to meet a fixed regulatory specification.
- B. A new mobile app whose features will be shaped by weekly user feedback.
- C. Any project with more than ten team members.
- D. Building a warehouse from approved blueprints.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

Midway through a sprint, a sales vice president asks a developer directly to add a customer-requested feature. The vice president controls the largest budget in the division. Who decides where the feature goes in the product backlog?

- A. The product owner.
- B. The developer who was asked.
- C. The vice president, because of the budget.
- D. The scrum master.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

At the end of a two-week sprint, a team wants to discuss why its daily stand-ups keep running long and how to improve code reviews. The team meets in a conference room with a new whiteboard wall. Which event is designed for this?

- A. The sprint review.
- B. Sprint planning.
- C. The sprint retrospective.
- D. The daily scrum.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

In which Scrum event do stakeholders inspect the working increment and give feedback on the product?

- A. The sprint retrospective.
- B. The daily scrum.
- C. Backlog refinement.
- D. The sprint review.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A team completed 28, 32, and 30 story points in its last three sprints. 240 points remain in the backlog. The team recently moved to a new ticketing tool with nicer charts. Using average velocity, how many more sprints are needed?

- A. 8 sprints
- B. 2.7 sprints
- C. 7.5 sprints
- D. 7,200 sprints

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A team must deliver 180 story points in 6 sprints. What average velocity is required?

- A. 180 points per sprint
- B. 30 points per sprint
- C. Exactly 30 every sprint, with no variation allowed.
- D. 1,080 points per sprint

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A support team using Kanban has 24 tickets in progress and finishes 8 tickets per day. The team lead wants to add color-coded swimlanes to the board. What is the average cycle time?

- A. 192 days
- B. It cannot be known without the sprint length.
- C. 3 days
- D. 8 days

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A team wants to cut average cycle time from 5 days to 3 days while throughput stays at 6 items per day. What WIP limit is needed?

- A. 0.5 items
- B. 18 items
- C. Remove WIP limits so more work can flow.
- D. 30 items

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A medical-device company must follow a regulated, phase-gated process for its hardware, but its companion app needs rapid user feedback. The company's founder was a cardiologist. Which approach fits?

- A. Whatever method the founder used in clinical work.
- B. Pure waterfall for both, because regulation always requires it everywhere.
- C. Pure Scrum for both.
- D. A hybrid: predictive for the regulated hardware and agile for the app.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A process map shows a purchase request takes 10 days, but only 2 hours are actual work; the rest is waiting for three approvals done one after another. The team uses a premium process-mapping tool. Which lean action best addresses this?

- A.** Cut the waiting by removing unneeded approvals or running them in parallel.
- B.** Speed up the 2 hours of actual work.
- C.** Add a fourth approval to improve quality.
- D.** Upgrade the process-mapping tool.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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12.

A PMO is considering an AI tool that forecasts schedule risk from past project data. The vendor's demo was impressive and the tool has a sleek interface. The PMO's historical data is incomplete and coded inconsistently. What is the main challenge to evaluate?

- A.** None, because AI tools always outperform human judgment.
- B.** License cost, as the only factor that matters.
- C.** The quality of the interface design.
- D.** Data quality, because forecasts are only as reliable as the historical data.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ____	☐ sure ☐ unsure ☐ guess
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STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A state agency must build a bridge-inspection database whose requirements are fixed by law and will not change, and the contract requires sign-off at defined phase gates. ~~The agency's CIO recently spoke at an agile conference.~~ Which approach fits best?

Target word: method fit **Decides:** Fixed requirements and phase-gate approvals.

A	Adjacent category	Continuous flow does not meet the contract's gate requirement.
B	Camouflage	A leader's interests do not change the project's characteristics.
C	Correct	Stable requirements and gated approvals suit predictive planning.
D	Absolute language	Agile is not always faster; fit depends on uncertainty.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

Which project is the strongest candidate for an adaptive (agile) approach?

Target word: work backward from method to project **Decides:** High requirement uncertainty.

A	Adjacent category	Defined requirements point to predictive.
B	Correct	Evolving requirements favor iterative delivery.
C	Confusion set	Team size does not decide the method; uncertainty does.
D	Inverted operation	Fixed design suits predictive.

3. Answer A Concept 2

Midway through a sprint, a sales vice president asks a developer directly to add a customer-requested feature. ~~The vice president controls the largest budget in the division.~~ Who decides where the feature goes in the product backlog?

Target word: who orders the backlog **Decides:** Backlog priority belongs to one role.

A	Correct	The product owner orders the product backlog.
B	Adjacent category	Developers own how sprint work gets done, not backlog order.
C	Camouflage	Budget size does not give backlog authority.
D	Confusion set	The scrum master coaches the process, not product priority.

4. Answer C Concept 3

At the end of a two-week sprint, a team wants to discuss why its daily stand-ups keep running long and how to improve code reviews. ~~The team meets in a conference room with a new whiteboard wall.~~ Which event is designed for this?

Target word: event for process improvement **Decides:** The topic is how the team works.

A	Confusion set	The review inspects the product with stakeholders.
B	Inverted operation	Looks ahead to the next sprint's work rather than back at the process.
C	Correct	The retrospective inspects and improves the team's process.
D	Adjacent category	A 15-minute sync on sprint progress, not process reflection.

5. Answer D Concept 3 · transfer

In which Scrum event do stakeholders inspect the working increment and give feedback on the product?

Target word: work backward from purpose to event **Decides:** Product inspection with stakeholders.

A	Inverted operation	Focuses on process, not product.
B	Adjacent category	For developers only, about sprint progress.
C	Confusion set	Prepares future items; it does not inspect the finished increment.
D	Correct	Stakeholders see the increment and shape what comes next.

6. Answer A Concept 4

A team completed 28, 32, and 30 story points in its last three sprints. 240 points remain in the backlog. ~~The team recently moved to a new ticketing tool with nicer charts.~~ Using average velocity, how many more sprints are needed?

Target word: sprints remaining **Decides:** Average velocity = $90 / 3 = 30$.

A	Correct	$240 / 30 = 8$.
B	Dropped element	Divides by the three-sprint total (90) instead of the average.
C	Wrong stem number	Uses the best sprint (32) instead of the average.
D	Inverted operation	Multiplies points by velocity.

7. Answer B Concept 4 · transfer

A team must deliver 180 story points in 6 sprints. What average velocity is required?

Target word: solve for velocity **Decides:** Velocity = points / sprints.

A	Wrong stem number	That is the whole backlog.
B	Correct	$180 / 6 = 30$.
C	Absolute language	Velocity is an average; individual sprints vary.
D	Inverted operation	Multiplies instead of dividing.

8. Answer C Concept 5

A support team using Kanban has 24 tickets in progress and finishes 8 tickets per day. ~~The team lead wants to add color-coded swimlanes to the board.~~ What is the average cycle time?

Target word: cycle time **Decides:** Cycle time = WIP / throughput.

A	Inverted operation	Multiplies WIP by throughput.
B	Adjacent category	Kanban has no sprints; flow metrics are enough.
C	Correct	$24 / 8 = 3$ days.
D	Wrong stem number	That is the daily throughput.

9. Answer B Concept 5 · transfer

A team wants to cut average cycle time from 5 days to 3 days while throughput stays at 6 items per day. What WIP limit is needed?

Target word: solve for WIP **Decides:** $WIP = \text{cycle time} \times \text{throughput}$.

A	Confusion set	Divides cycle time by throughput.
B	Correct	$3 \times 6 = 18$.
C	Inverted operation	More WIP raises cycle time.
D	Wrong stem number	That is the current WIP (5×6).

10. Answer D Concept 6

A medical-device company must follow a regulated, phase-gated process for its hardware, but its companion app needs rapid user feedback. ~~The company's founder was a cardiologist.~~ Which approach fits?

Target word: method for mixed needs **Decides:** Regulated hardware plus fast-changing software.

A	Camouflage	The founder's background does not decide the method.
B	Absolute language	The app can iterate within compliance.
C	Dropped element	Drops the regulated phase-gate requirement.
D	Correct	Each part gets the method that fits it.

11. Answer A Concept 7

A process map shows a purchase request takes 10 days, but only 2 hours are actual work; the rest is waiting for three approvals done one after another. ~~The team uses a premium process mapping tool.~~ Which lean action best addresses this?

Target word: biggest waste to cut **Decides:** Most of the lead time is waiting.

A	Correct	Targets the non-value-adding time.
B	Adjacent category	Works on the small value-adding part, not the waste.
C	Inverted operation	Adds more waiting.
D	Camouflage	The tool does not create or remove the delay.

12. Answer D Concept 8

A PMO is considering an AI tool that forecasts schedule risk from past project data. ~~The vendor's demo was impressive and the tool has a sleek interface.~~ The PMO's historical data is incomplete and coded inconsistently. What is the main challenge to evaluate?

Target word: key adoption challenge **Decides:** Forecasts depend on data quality.

A	Absolute language	AI supports judgment and can be wrong.
B	Adjacent category	Cost matters, but the stem's deciding fact is the data.
C	Camouflage	A polished interface does not fix bad data.
D	Correct	Poor inputs produce poor predictions.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	2	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	4	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	5	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Predictive vs. adaptive fit	Stable, well-known requirements and phase-gated approvals favor predictive (waterfall); uncertain or evolving requirements favor adaptive (agile).	Assuming agile is always better or faster.	How settled the requirements are.
2	Scrum roles	The product owner orders the product backlog; the scrum master coaches the process and removes impediments; developers self-organize the sprint work.	Letting a senior outsider or the scrum master set backlog priority.	A new request arriving mid-sprint.
3	Sprint review vs. retrospective	The sprint review inspects the product increment with stakeholders; the retrospective inspects how the team worked.	Swapping the two events.	Product feedback vs. process improvement.
4	Velocity forecasting	Sprints remaining = remaining story points / average velocity.	Using the best sprint or dividing by the total of several sprints.	Several past sprint totals and a remaining backlog.
5	Kanban flow and Little's Law	Kanban limits work in progress and manages flow; average cycle time = WIP / throughput.	Thinking more WIP speeds delivery, or looking for sprints in Kanban.	Items in progress and items finished per day.
6	Hybrid approaches	Hybrid methods combine predictive control where required (regulation, hardware) with adaptive work where feedback matters.	Forcing one method on every part of a project.	One project with both regulated and fast-changing parts.
7	Lean waste removal	Lean targets non-value-adding time such as waiting and handoffs, which often dwarfs actual work time.	Speeding up the value-adding work instead of cutting waste.	Total lead time much longer than touch time.
8	Evaluating emerging PM tools	New tools, including AI, are judged on fit, data quality, adoption, and cost; they support rather than replace judgment.	Being swayed by demos or interfaces, or assuming AI always beats people.	An impressive demo next to weak underlying data.

Course scope (public description): In Project Management Methodologies, the learner will explore the intricacies of project management methodologies, delving into the benefits, limitations, and core principles that underpin various approaches. The learner will apply an appropriate project management methodology to effectively plan, execute, and monitor project activities, honing their skills in project management implementation. Additionally, the learner will critically evaluate the benefits and challenges of adopting emerging tools and software in project management, equipping them with the knowledge and adaptability needed to navigate the evolving landscape of project management practices.